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LinkedIn: <https://linkedin.com/in/cbmhessels> | GitHub: <https://github.com/khessels> |

Portfolio: <https://khessels.com>

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Summary

Senior Full Stack Software Engineer with 15+ years of experience building scalable backend systems using LAMP/LEMP stacks, Laravel/PHP, and Node.js. Proven leadership in architecting distributed systems, managing agile development teams, and delivering enterprise-grade software solutions. Skilled in database design, messaging systems, and full-cycle product development.

Education

University of Amsterdam, Electronics Dept. (ETS)

Master's Degree in Electronics, Digital Logic / Logic Design (1986 – 1990)

Skills

Languages: PHP (v5–v8), Node.js, JavaScript, Python, C, MicroPython, Bash, Pascal, Arduino

Frameworks: Laravel, Express, Vue, React, jQuery, Dojo, Socket.IO

Tools & DevOps: Docker, NGINX, Apache, Git, Bitbucket, Redis, Memcached, Cron, WSL

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, RDS), Google Cloud, DigitalOcean

Databases: MySQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Cassandra, SQLite, SQL Server

Soft Skills: Architecture Design, Team Leadership, Product Management, Agile/Scrum, Technical Writing

CoPilot, AI

Work Experience

Signal Secure Ltd

Team Lead / Product Manager

June 2016 – Dec 2023

- - Led development for two major product lines: automotive IoT and smart-cart POS systems.
- - Architected global back-end systems handling telemetry and device control.
- - Managed cross-functional development team and led Agile ceremonies.
- - Oversaw firmware integration and coordination with hardware teams.
- - Communicated product vision and progress to upper management.

Loans Canada

Full Stack Developer

Jan 2024 – June 2024

- - Built and internationalized WordPress site for loan leads business.
- - Developed Laravel-based backend features and optimized frontend/backend integration.

Select Finance

Team Lead / Full Stack Developer

Nov 2024 – March 2025

- - Created website with integrated CRM and product scraping engine.
- - Developed a Laravel CMS to offer WordPress-like content management.
- - Handled DevOps and led a small development team.

Projects

Smart-Car IoT System — Signal Secure

Built a telemetry platform for connected vehicles with features like GPS tracking, engine control, and data aggregation from distributed hardware.

Amazon Go-style POS System — Signal Secure

Developed a smart-cart POS solution for a US-based retailer with global deployment. Included backend services, APIs, and coordination with firmware and hardware teams.

Additional Highlights

- - Defined feature specs, milestones, and hiring requirements for product teams.
- - Led scrums, onboarded engineers, and mentored junior developers.
- - Conducted R&D into emerging technologies and presented findings to management.
- - Championed backend architecture and integration strategies across departments.